



BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS



Auditor Book



BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS

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Chapter 4: Identification of Technical Area and Appropriate Classification of Products by Activity (CPA) Code

0.General:

Identification of technical area is a primary requirement for MSCS before the contractual agreement is made. In addition, identification of technical area, processes involved, statutory regulations and standards, enables an auditor to carry out audit more effectively.

Technical area need to be identified by the MSCO at the time of recording application for deploying the right person for the audit. Based on the technical area, the most appropriate auditor is selected from the pool of auditors to ensure team competence. In order to assist auditors, the online module of BIS may be used to identify the technical area, CPA code, technical sector, process requirements, regulatory requirements and IAF code.

1.0. Identifying CPA Code:

There are two ways to identify technical area and related requirements which are listed below:

To use this facility, the auditor needs to login and use the interactive CPA code search menu under documents. Once the CPA code is identified, go to section 2.0 for identifying technical area.

(a) Through key words of subject:

If you know the subject, key in four letters of the subject. This will give a list of options from which the CPA code can be identified. Once CPA is identified, go to section 2.0 of this chapter for identifying technical area.

(b) Through blank search:

If you do not know the exact subject word, you may give a search using blank and this will lead you to sequential search into the tables enabling you to identify the exact CPA code. After identifying CPA code, you can identify technical area by the method given in section 2.0 of this chapter.

2.0. Identifying the Technical Area and Sector:

Once, the CPA code is identified, using the same menu, search again with the CPA code. This search lists down the applicable technical sectors/technical area. Technical sector is a collection of technical areas. In many cases, even an auditor qualified in technical sector could be used even if he does not have the

applicable CPA code.

3.0. Process controls related to technical area:

After identifying the technical sector and technical area using the menu "Technical area information", the process control requirements, terminology, major processes, statutory and regulatory requirements, evaluation references and IAF codes as applicable to the identified technical area can be identified. BIS has documented knowledge related to 37 sectors and more than 185 technical areas. This information is based on the dynamic knowledge bank developed by MSCD department.

While carrying out the audit, the processes need to be evaluated and the controls exercised by the auditee in these processes are ensured and are reflected in the observation sheets.

Experts/Auditor-Experts are aided by technical area information created in the knowledge bank.

Team Leaders are expected to report back to MSCD for any information leading to the upgradation of knowledge bank.

4.0. References

MSC F6.4-22-Observation sheet